extern



UI/UX DESIGN | PRODUCT MANAGEMENT

BeReal.

BeReal Passport And Community Boards

Enhancement Proposal • 2026

Presented by Lashawn Fofung, MBA, PMP, CSM, CSPO

PROJECT AT A GLANCE

From Teardown To Tested Pitch In Five Steps

01

Discover

BeReal UI/UX teardown and corporate snapshot

02

Define

Introvert persona and 5-stage journey map

03

Design

7-screen user flow, UI states and hooks

04

Prototype & test

Clickable prototype, 5-person focus group, survey

05

Pitch

Test report, Refine recommendation, pitch video

ROLE

UI/UX designer and product manager (solo project)

METHODS

Product teardown, persona, journey mapping, usability testing, focus group, survey

TOOLS

Canva, Claude (clickable prototype and promo reel), Google Forms, GitHub Pages

OUTCOME

Concept validated with direction: 4 of 5 testers would open BeReal more often. Recommendation: refine, then retest

Live prototype: lashawnfofung.github.io/BeReal-RealProcess

AGENDA

What We’ll Cover

01



Overview & research

The problem
Research: where BeReal loses people

02



Design

The seven-screen user flow
UI states and hooks
Prototype walkthrough
Design decisions

03



User testing

Focus group setup
Survey results
Key findings

04



Recommendation & reflection

Refine, then retest
Staged rollout and metrics
What I learned

PART 1 OF 4

01

Overview & research

Why people drift away from BeReal, and what the research showed.



01 Overview & research

02 Design

03 User testing

04 Recommendation & reflection

THE INTRO

Driving Authentic Daily Engagement & Long-Term Retention on BeReal.

THE PROBLEM STATEMENT

- Post- Notification Slump
- Single-Touchpoint Limit
- Passive Feed Stagnation
- Casual Drop-Off Risk

THE ENHANCEMENT

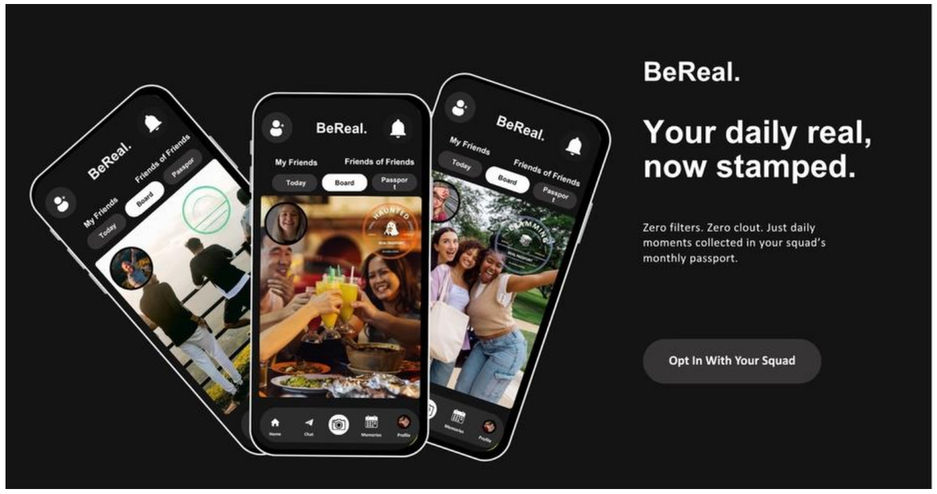
- Midnight Theme Prompt
- Squad Board Collages
- Vector Passport Stamps
- Monthly Capsule Vault

THE MAU IMPACT

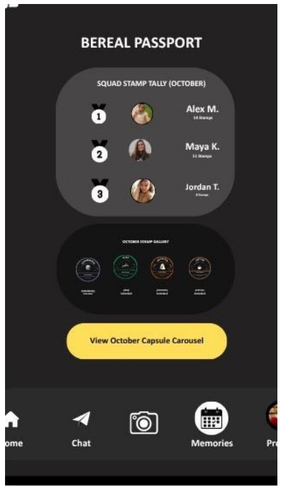
- 2.5x Daily Opens/User
- Organic Peer Accountability
- 30-Day Retention Vaulting
- Zero Vanity Metric Loops

Time to Be Real.

BeReal.







RESEARCH

Where BeReal Loses People

15M → 6M

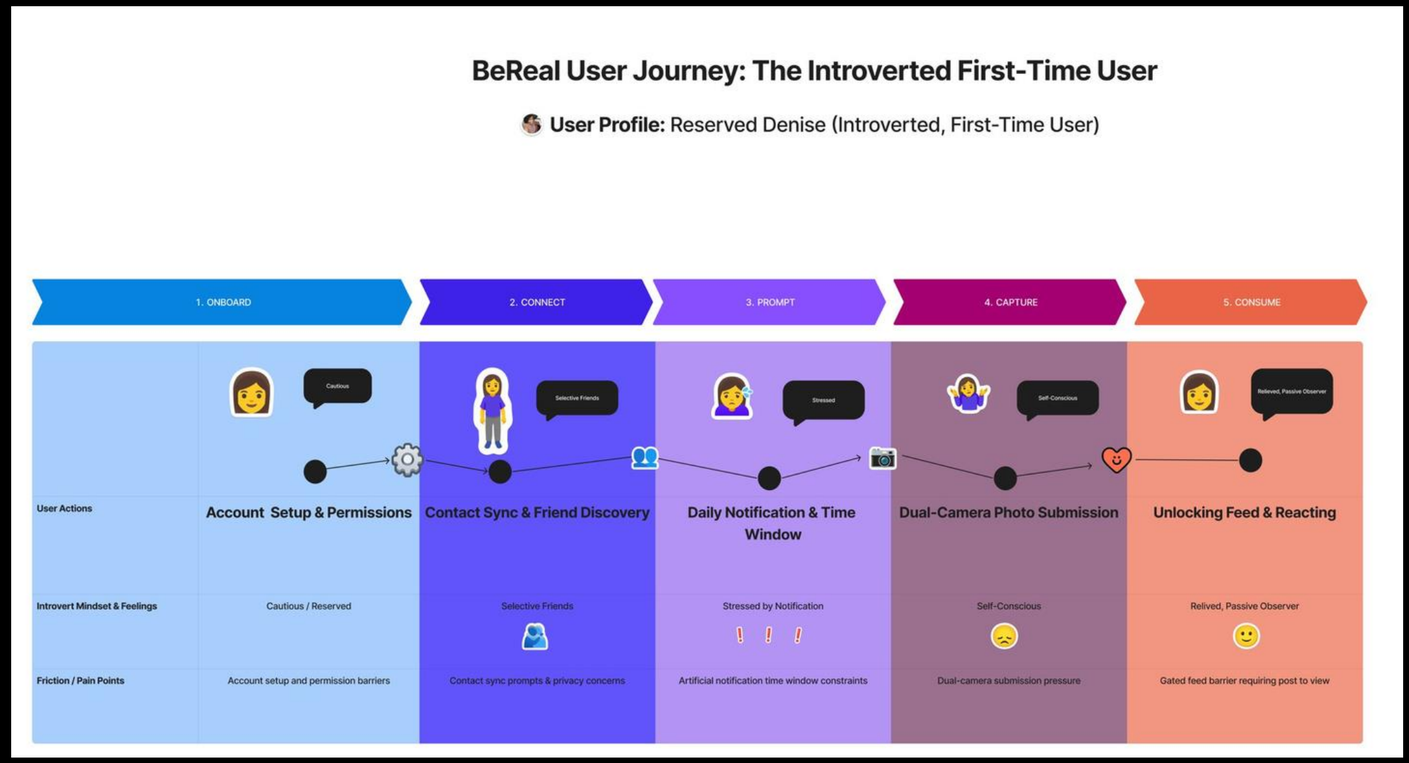
BeReal daily users, October 2022 to spring 2023 (The New York Times)

“I’m in the middle of working… I wasn’t expecting to take a photo right now.”

Denise, introvert persona, at the prompt stage

WHAT IT MEANT

Pressure points (the 2-minute window, the gated feed) push people away. More urgency won’t win them back; a better reason to post will.



User journey map: introverted first-time user (Onboard → Connect → Prompt → Capture → Consume)

View Image: https://github.com/LashawnFofung/BeReal-RealProcess/blob/main/User%20Journey/BeReal%20User%20Journey%20For%20An%20Introvert%20transparent.png

PART 2 OF 4

02

Design

A seven-screen habit loop, and the decisions behind it.



01 Overview & research

02 Design

03 User testing

04 Recommendation & reflection

THE USER FLOW

Seven Screens, One Habit Loop

The 7-screen happy path from start to finish.

1 **Today Screen** → 2 **Capture Toggle** → 3 **Board Select** → 4 **Post Confirm**

5 **Capsule / Board Detail** → 6 **Passport & Leaderboard** → 7 **Settings / Opt-out**

↺ *loops back to Today Screen the next day, with a fresh theme*

First-time vs. repeat:

First-time users see a one-time intro overlay on Today Screen; repeat users land directly on the theme hero — no onboarding friction after day one.

Promo Reel: https://youtube.com/shorts/exXoJ6NqmbI

THE PROTOTYPE

A Screen-By-Screen Rundown

Today Screen	Daily theme + reminder bubble + come-back banner
Capture Toggle	Theme Post / Random Post toggle + state demo panel
Board Select	Capsule collage, voting, comments, empty state
Post Confirm	Confirm to post photo to community board or usual post.
Capsule / Board Details	Choose to view capsule collection or see board details.
BeReal Passport	Stamp collection grid + streak cue
Leaderboard	Squad ranking + sponsor banner mockup
Settings / Opt-out	Control settings for name and password. User can opt-out of community board.

EMOTIONAL TONE

In Small Amounts, Calm, Real, Human.

“No one’s posted to this board yet — be the first!”

The empty state best captures BeReal’s tone — it would have been easy to leave this as a dead end or a guilt trip. Instead, it stays warm and invitational, the same register BeReal uses everywhere else.

UI STATES COVERED

Designed For More Than The Happy Path

What happens when things are empty, loading , or go wrong.



Empty

Board Selection / Capsule

“No one’s posted to this board yet — be the first!”



Loading

Post Confirmation

“Stamping your passport…”



Success

Post Confirmation

“Stamp earned! Added to Coffee Shop”



Error

Post Confirmation

“That didn’t go through — let’s try again.”

MAU-ORIENTED HOOKS

Invite People Back, Never Pressure Them



Reminder bubble

“3 friends already posted to Coffee Shop today”

Social curiosity, not an alert



Soft streak cue

“You’ve been real 3 days in a row”

No loss framing, no streak-breaking guilt



Come-back banner

“Come back tomorrow for a new theme”

Sets up tomorrow’s open without pushing it

BACK CAMERA — FULL FRAME

FRONT CAMERA — OVERLAY

FEATURE CONCEPT - OCTOBER 2026

BeReal.

BEREAL PASSPORT & COMMUNITY BOARDS

Your daily BeReal, now stamped.

Collect everyday moments with your squad. Create a shared monthly board, unlock playful passport stamps, and save the months as a capsule. No public likes. No filters. Just your people.

01 • Capture First

02 •Pick a Board

03 •Collect Stamps

04 •Archive Together

Prototype flow: Try to capture button, choose a community board after the photo, react to a board moment, and explore the Octorber Passport and Vault.

DESIGN PRINCIPLES

Pitch-black canvas • Candid dual-camera feel • Tactile pastel stamp ink • Private squad reactions • Monthly collection loop



Interactive Prototype:
https://claude.ai/artifact/QouixAtcmRQXoxXEiUsXgm
or
https://lashawnfofung.github.io/BeReal-RealProcess/

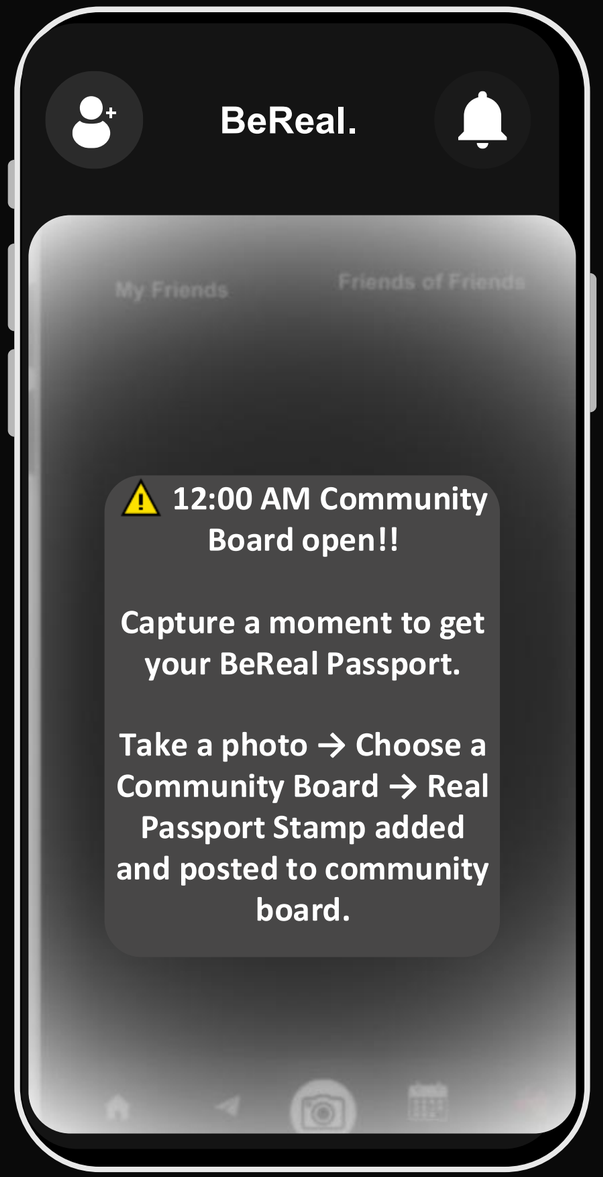
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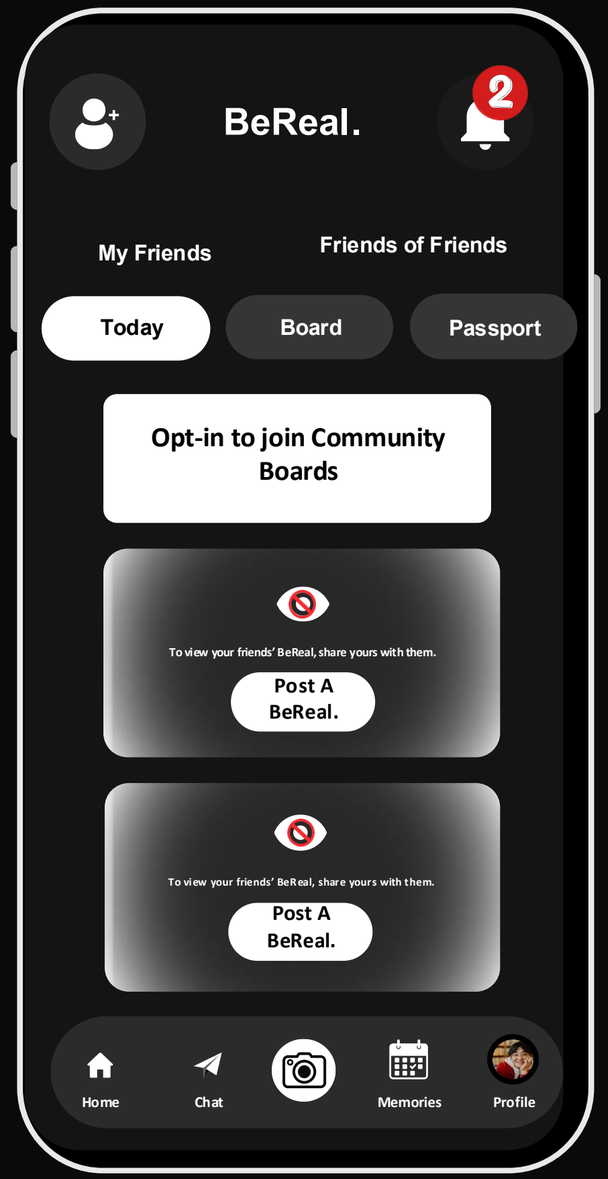
BEREAL PASSPORT & COMMUNITY BOARDS

Today Screen *(New User)*

- User will receive an alert prompt at 12:00 AM their local time.
  - Specific time to reset for tracking
- User opens app at their convenience
  - Not dependent of Timed posting
- 1 of 3 New Views for feature
- A button for user to opt-in to join Community Boards
  - Opt-out default if user does not opt-in



User Receives Daily Alert



User Opens App

FEATURE CONCEPT - OCTOBER 2026

BeReal.

BEREAL PASSPORT & COMMUNITY BOARDS

Capture Toggle

- User takes a photo
- Choose Post Type
  - SEND
    - Random Post
    - No BeReal Passport
  - COMMUNITY BOARD
    - Themed Post
    - Adds BeReal Passport to post



User Takes Photo

Add Caption & Choose Post Type

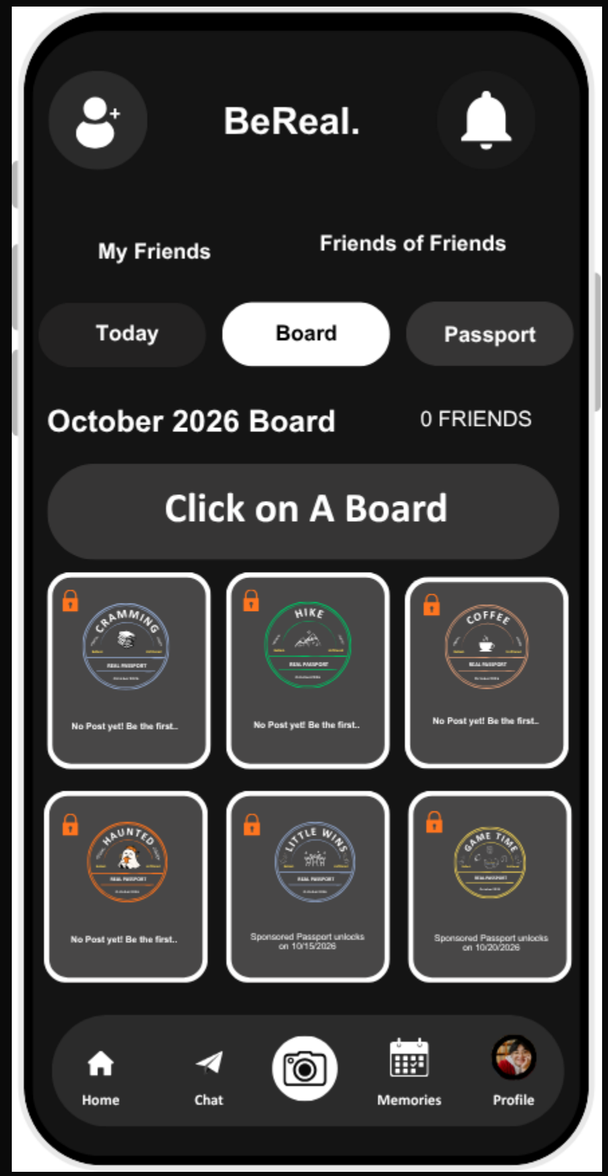
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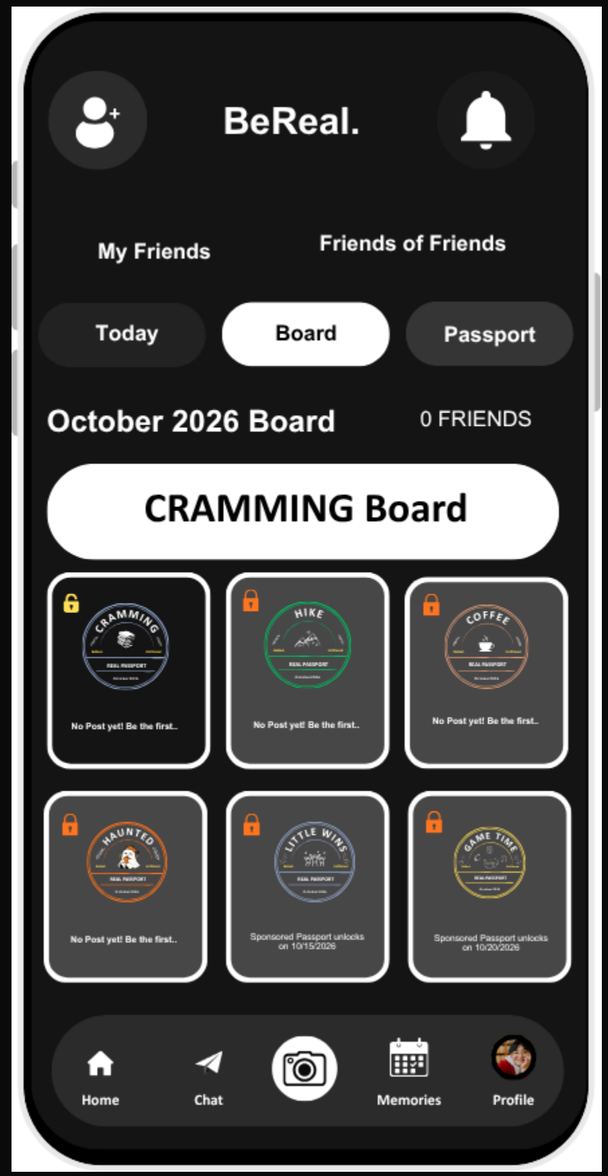
BEREAL PASSPORT & COMMUNITY BOARDS

Board Select

- Directed from Capture Screen to Board Screen
- User Chooses A Board
  - Visual Confirmation
  - Highlighted card switch from grey to white with name of selected board.
  - Key Icon Changes from Lock to Unlock



User Chooses A



Board Chosen

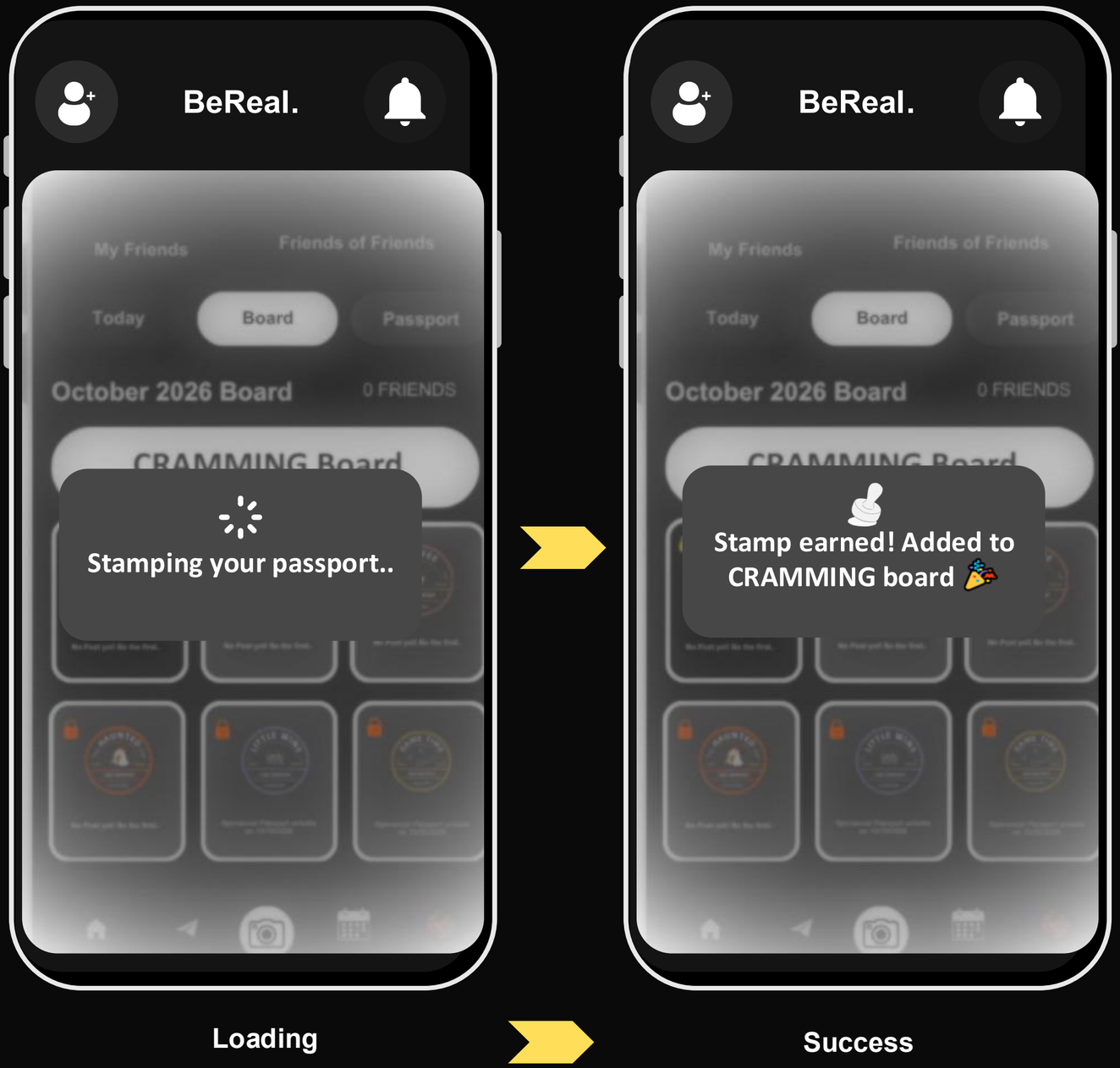
FEATURE CONCEPT - OCTOBER 2026

BeReal.

BEREAL PASSPORT & COMMUNITY BOARDS

Post Confirm

- Happy path messages:
  - Loading
    - *“Stamping your passport..”*
  - Success
    - *“Stamp earned! Added to CRAMMING board 🎉”*
- If something goes wrong, a message will display:
  - Empty state
    - *“No one’s posted to this board yet - be the first!”*
  - Error state
    - *“⚠️ That didn’t go through. Let’s try again.”*



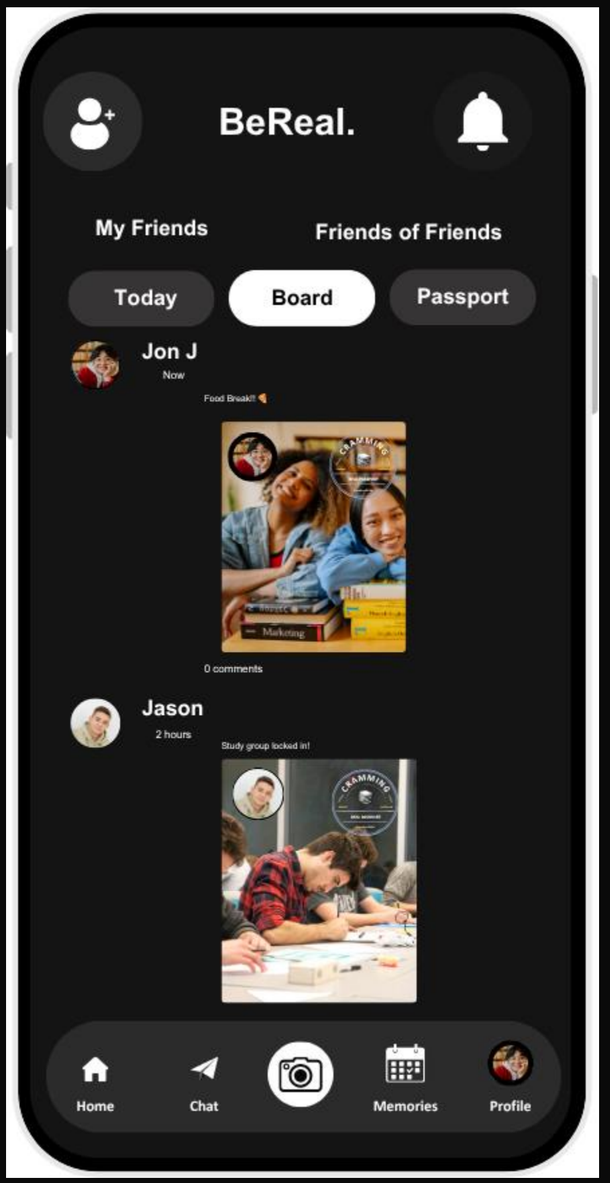
FEATURE CONCEPT - OCTOBER 2026

BeReal.

BEREAL PASSPORT & COMMUNITY BOARDS

Post Confirm

- Post added in Cramming Community Board feed
- User will see BeReal Passport stamp added to their photo
- User will be able to view other user’s community board post with BeReal Passport stamp



FEATURE CONCEPT - OCTOBER 2026

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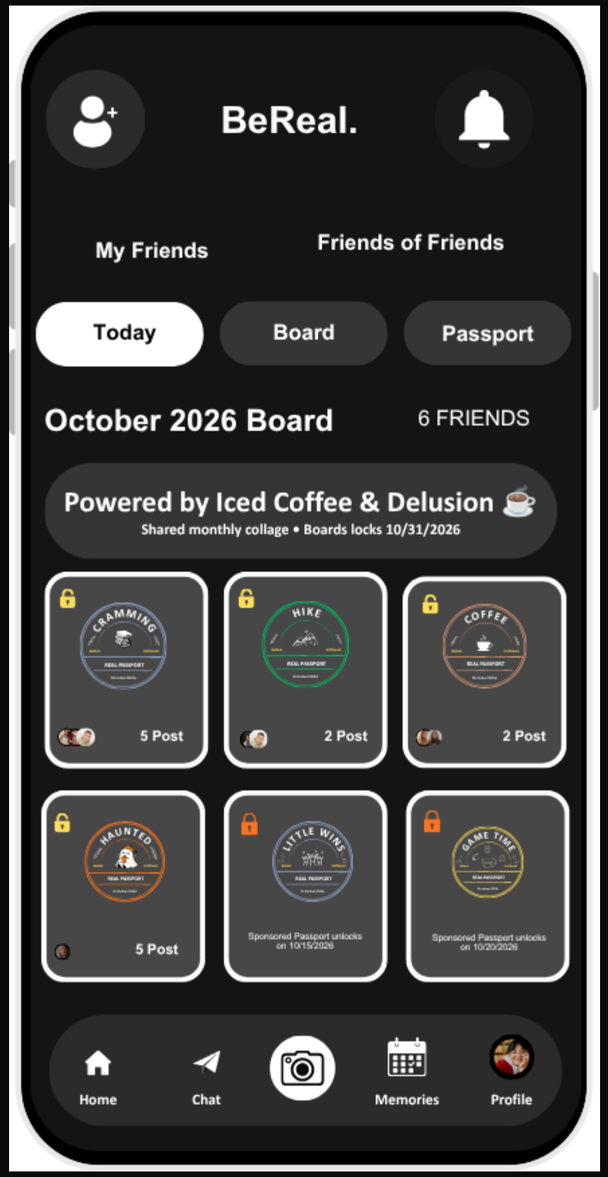
BEREAL PASSPORT & COMMUNITY BOARDS

Today Screen *(Returning User)*

- **MAU increase**
- Daily Prompt
- Reminders
  - Friends Posted to Board
  - Streaks
  - Comeback banner
- Once user has opt-in to join 1 or more community boards, ‘Today Screen’ will show October snapshot.
- Snapshot view of all the community boards available for the month (themed & sponsored)
- Each community board snapshot shows:
  - State (locked or unlocked)
  - Image of Real Passport stamp
  - Friends who have posted
  - Number of Post



Daily Prompt



Snapshot

FEATURE CONCEPT - OCTOBER 2026

BeReal.

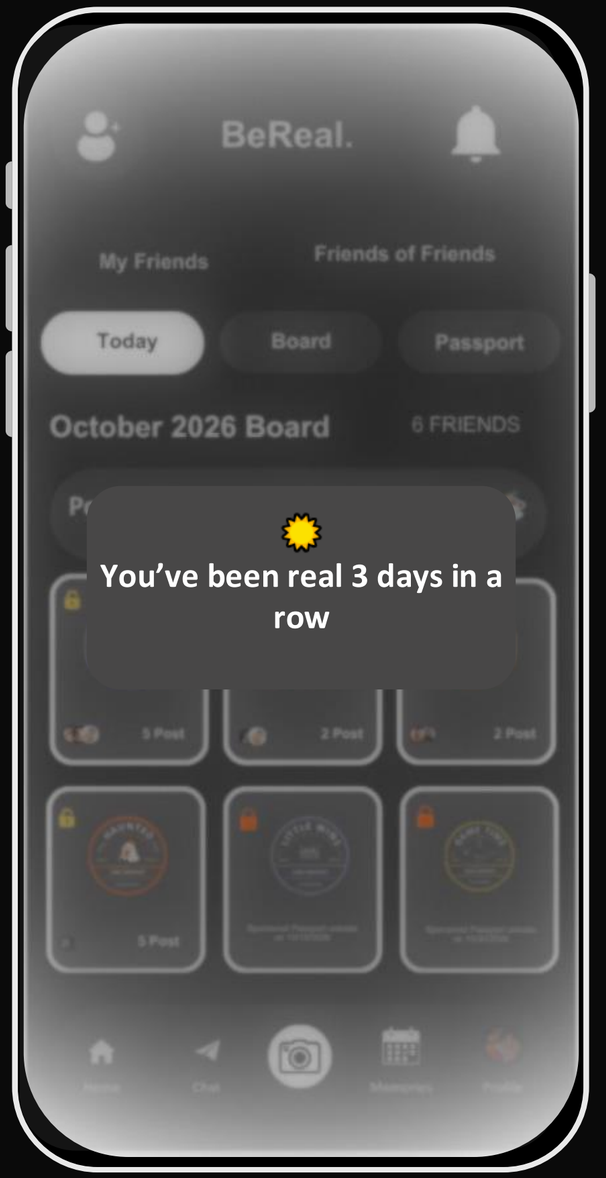
BEREAL PASSPORT & COMMUNITY BOARDS

Reminders

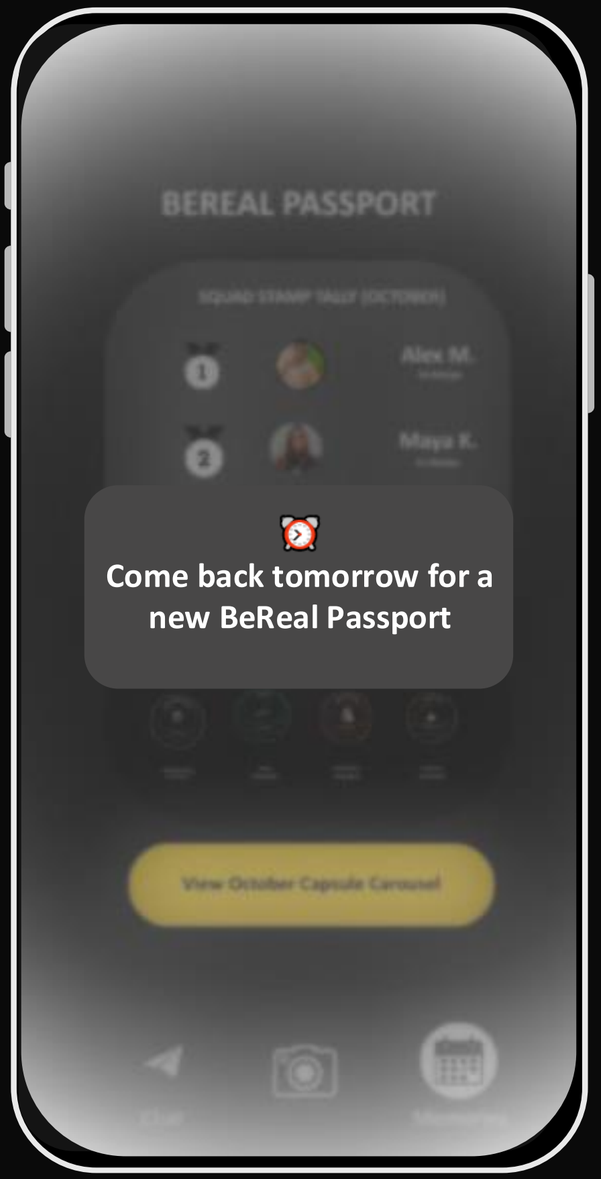
- **MAU increase**
- Reminders
  - Friends Posted to Board
    - Social curiosity
  - Streaks
    - No loss framing
    - No streak-breaking guilt
  - Comeback banner
    - Sets up for tomorrow's engagement
- No pressure to post



Reminder Bubble



Soft Streak Cue



Come-back Banner

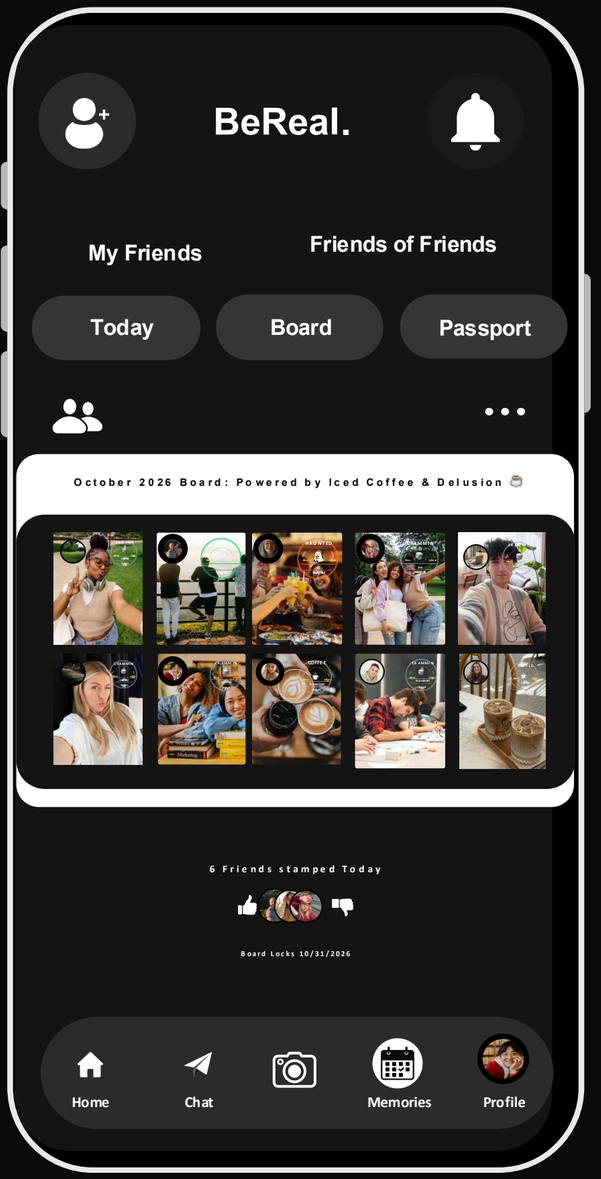
FEATURE CONCEPT - OCTOBER 2026

BeReal.

BEREAL PASSPORT & COMMUNITY BOARDS

Capsule / Board Details

- **MAU increase**
- Past Boards are stored in ‘Memories’ as a Capsule
  - View all Community Boards Posting in a carousel view
- Carousel View
  - Snapshot
  - Expand out
    - User can click on image to view post
    - Future Enhancement
      - 2-Column Grid scroll
- Board details shows:
  - Friends who participated
  - Number of Likes or Dislikes



FEATURE CONCEPT - OCTOBER 2026

BeReal.

October 2026 Release

BEREAL PASSPORT & COMMUNITY BOARDS

BeReal Passport

- **MAU increase**
- New Theme Designs released monthly
- Sponsored Ad designs
- Gamified engangement
  - Leadership board
- User can view their BeReal Passport Collection on the ‘Passport’ tab













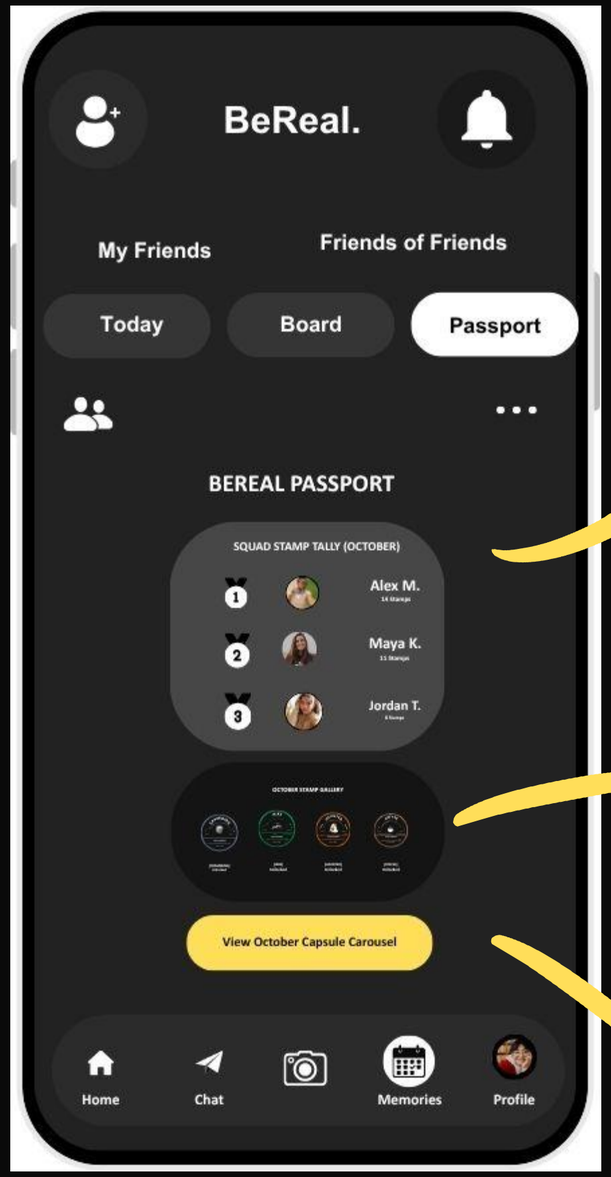
FEATURE CONCEPT - OCTOBER 2026

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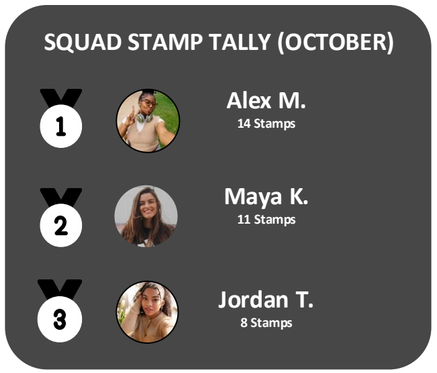
BEREAL PASSPORT & COMMUNITY BOARDS

Leaderboard

- **MAU Increase**
- Design for push notification landing pages and in-app feature announcements.
- Leadership Board
- Passport Collection
- Quick Link to Capsule Carousel



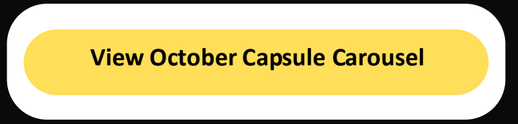
Leadership Board



User BeReal Passport Collection



Button to Take User to Memories



FEATURE CONCEPT - OCTOBER 2026

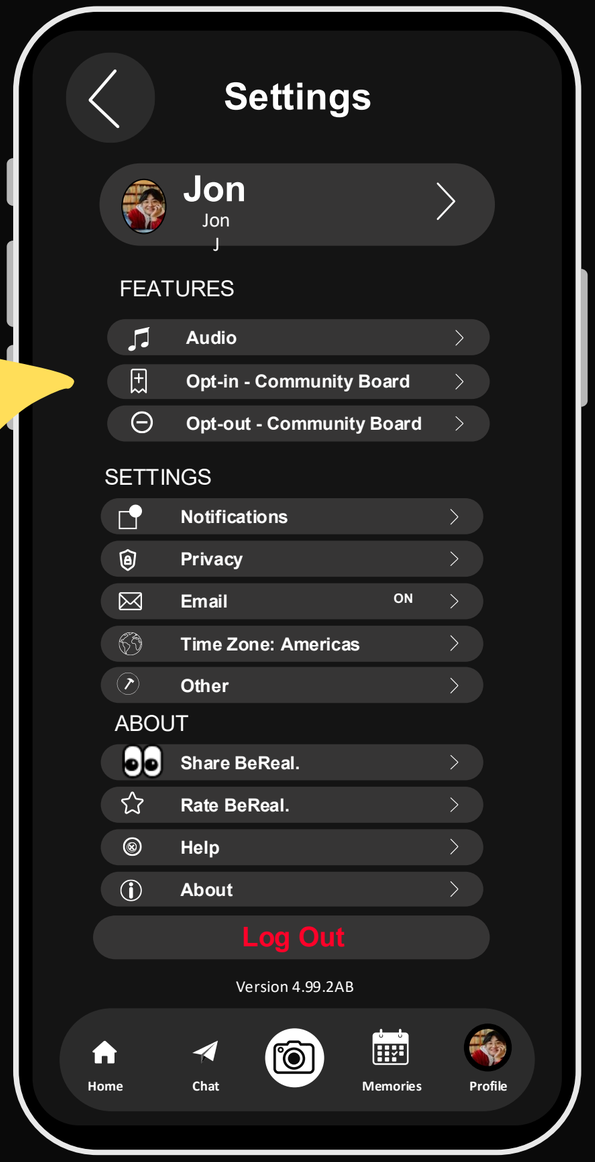
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BEREAL PASSPORT & COMMUNITY BOARDS

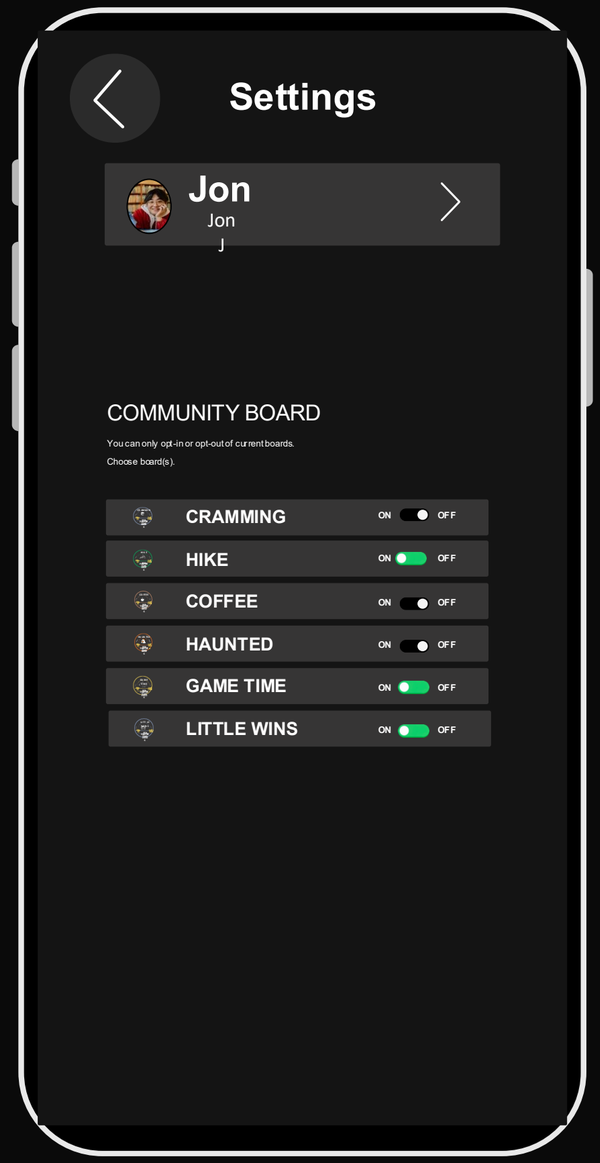
Settings / Opt-out

- Manage **Community Board(s)** Participation
  - Easily Opt-in or Opt-out
  - Updated Setting Screen
  - New screen to easily add or remove

Opt-in (Join) or **Opt-out (Leave)**



User Selects



Select Board(s)

DESIGN DECISIONS

Key Decisions And Their Trade-offs

DECISION	WHY	TRADE-OFF
Pick a board after the photo	Capture stays instant, exactly like BeReal today	One extra step; testers noticed the taps
Opt-in only	No one is pushed into boards; random posts still work	Smaller reach at launch
Squad-only reactions, no public likes	Avoids performance and vanity metrics	Less viral spread
Hooks that invite, never guilt	No loss framing, no streak-breaking shame	A softer nudge than classic streaks
Monthly boards that close into a capsule	A keepsake, not an endless treadmill	Content resets every month

WHY THIS STILL FEELS LIKE BEREAL

Additive, Not Addictive

Same real photo

No filters, no retakes, no new content requirement , and tagging is a layer on top.

Opt-in only

Random, untagged posting stays fully supported for anyone who ignores boards.

Time-boxed

Boards close at month end and become a keepsake, not an infinite treadmill.

No shame mechanics

Stamps and the leaderboard reward participation, no streak-loss messaging.

PART 3 OF 4

03

User testing

Five people, three tasks, one survey: what users actually did and said.



01 Overview & research

02 Design

03 User testing

04 Recommendation & reflection

USER TESTING

Five people, 40 Minutes, Three Tasks

WHO TOOK PART

1 **Daily user**
Uses BeReal most days

2 **Occasional users**
A few times a month

2 **Rare users**
Rarely or never

HOW THE SESSION RAN

1. **Warm-up** 5 min
   How often people open and post on BeReal today.

2. **Prototype tasks** 15 min
   Respond to the 12:00 AM alert and post; find this month's stamps; explore the streak and leaderboard. Participants thought aloud.

3. **Debrief** 15 min
   Interest, clarity, and whether it feels more or less like BeReal.

4. **Survey** 5 min
   8 questions: usage, four 1–5 scales, launch yes/maybe/no, two open-ended.

In person · October 20, 2026 · clickable prototype, observer notes and a Google Form

SURVEY RESULTS

4 of 5 Would Open BeReal More Often

4 of 5

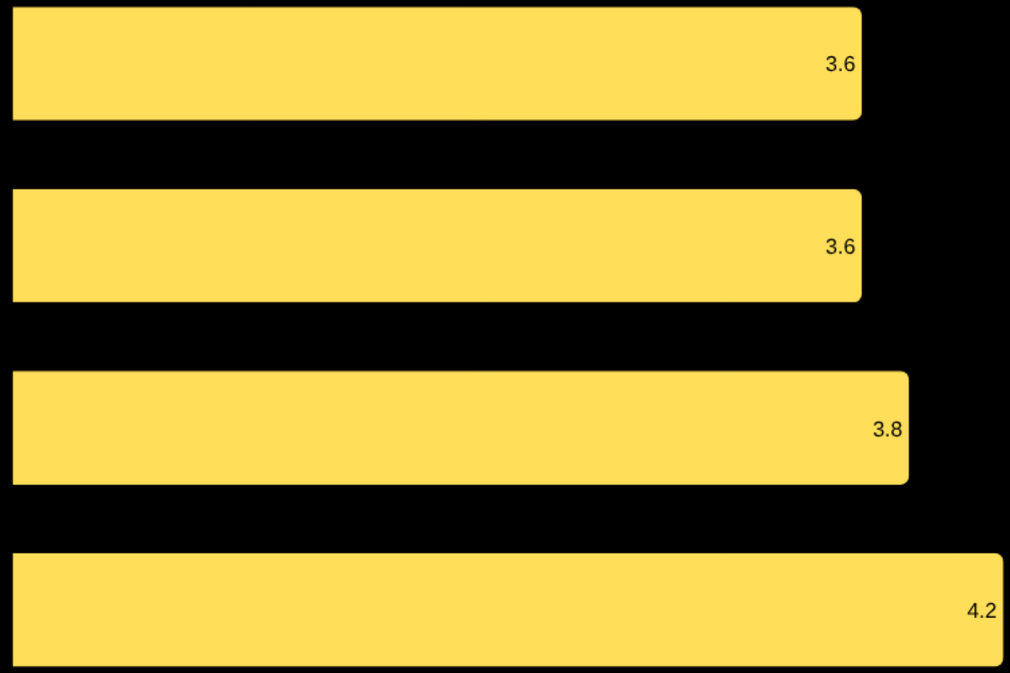
rated 4 or 5 for understanding, authenticity and opening BeReal more often

4.2 / 5

hooks felt low-pressure, the highest score; no one rated them below 3

3 · 1 · 1

Yes · Maybe · No to launching the feature



One non-user rated the first three questions 1. Without that response they average 4.25, 4.25 and 4.5.

KEY FINDINGS

What We Learned

1 · MAU SIGNAL

Brings back occasional users

“I'd definitely open the app more often because of this.”

Both occasional users rated “open more often” a 5

2 · USABILITY

Too many taps from capture to post

“There are a few too many button clicks in this flow.”

Raised twice in the session and again in the survey

3 · VALUE

Stamps and the Passport are the draw

“The passport stamp designs themselves look really cool!”

Most-liked: layout, stamps, navigation, community posting

4 · AUTHENTICITY

No pressure, but complexity hurts fit

“It feels less authentic and overly complex.”

Hooks scored 4.2 / 5 for low pressure; one non-user found it complex

PART 4 OF 4

04

Recommendation & reflection

What BeReal should do next, and what I learned along the way.



01 Overview & research

02 Design

03 User testing

04 Recommendation & reflection

RECOMMENDATION

Refine, Then Retest

PROCEED · REFINE · PIVOT

Refine

Keep the concept. Users valued the stamps, Passport and squad boards, and the hooks added no pressure. Fix the friction before a wider test.

Retest with 7–10 people, including more non-users. Measure taps and time from capture to a stamped post.

1

Cut taps from capture to stamp

Remember the last board used, or pick a board right on the compose screen.

Most repeated issue

2

Make SEND vs COMMUNITY BOARD clear

Add a one-line hint the first time someone sees the choice.

“Not sure which one does what”

3

Add a first-use explainer

One screen for people new to boards.

A non-user didn't see the point

4

Keep hooks optional, same tone

They already read as motivating.

Highest survey score (4.2 / 5)

RECOMMENDATIONS

A Staged Rollout, Starting Small

Phase 0

Prototype & test

Done. Clickable prototype tested with 5 people; 4 of 5 would open BeReal more often.

COMPLETE

Phase 1

Refine & retest

Fewer taps, clearer post type, first-use explainer. Retest with 7–10 people.

NEXT

Phase 2

MVP

1–2 boards, one friend-group cohort. Measure adoption and DAU/MAU lift.

Phase 3

Full rollout

4–5 concurrent monthly boards. Passport and leaderboard shipped in full.

Phase 4

Monetization (pilot)

Explore sponsor-branded boards, subject to brand-safety review.

Decision needed

Approve a short refine-and-retest sprint, then a limited MVP with one friend-group cohort and one board to validate the MAU hypothesis before further engineering investment.

SUCCESS METRICS & PRIORITIZATION

What We'll Watch, and Why This Ranks High

Success metrics

- DAU / MAU ratio (stickiness)
- Daily open rate
- D7 and D30 retention
- % of posts tagged to a board
- Passport / leaderboard visits
- **Taps and time from capture to stamped post (new, from testing)**

Early signal from testing
4 of 5 testers would open BeReal more often. The strongest pull was among occasional users.

RICE snapshot (indicative)

Reach	High
Impact	Medium-High
Confidence	Medium (5-person test)
Effort	Medium

Directional. A 5-person focus group shows direction, not proof; refine the scoring with Phase 2 MVP data.

REFLECTION

What I learned, and What I'd Do Differently

1

Complexity, not pressure, was the real risk

The hooks scored highest for low pressure (4.2/5). The one non-user's complaint was that it felt "overly complex."

2

Test with the people you want to win

Occasional users loved it; a non-user didn't see the point. Two non-users weren't enough to know why.

3

A working prototype beats a static mock

Clicking through the flow surfaced the extra taps in one session, something slides alone never showed.

NEXT TIME

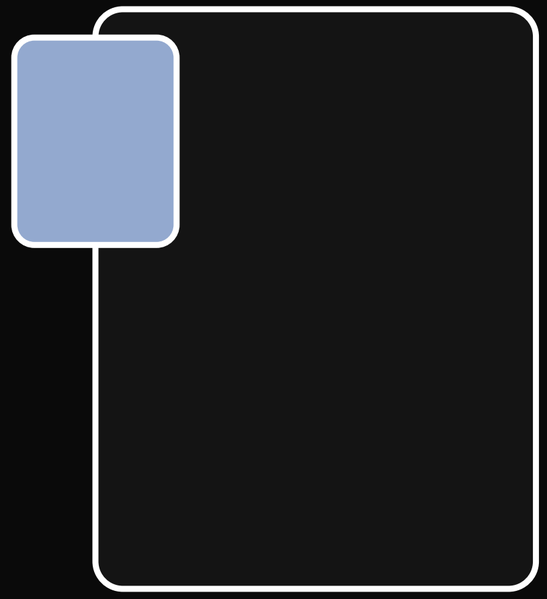
Recruit 7–10 testers, with more non-users

Measure taps and time-on-task during each task

Test the hooks over a full week, not one session

THANK YOU

Be real.
Not polished.



Prototype — Be*Real Passport And Community Boards*

Prepared 2026

Presented by Lashawn Fofung, MBA, PMP, CSM, CSPO